

Dexamethasone

(Decadron)

I. Classification

- Corticosteroid

II. Action(s)

- Decreased inflammation by suppression of neutrophil migration, decreased production of inflammatory mediators, and reversal of increased capillary permeability; suppresses normal immune response.

III. Indication(s)

- Allergic Reaction / Anaphylaxis
- Asthma / COPD

IV. Contraindications

- Known hypersensitivity
- Systemic Fungal Infection

V. Precautions

- Caution in patients with active infections (bacterial, viral)
- Caution in patients with recent live viral vaccinations
- Caution in immunosuppressed patients
- Caution in ocular infections (especially herpes simplex infections)
- Caution in hyperglycemia and diabetes – worsens hyperglycemia
- Caution in CHF

VI. Drug interactions

- Live viral vaccines

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 10 mg IV / IO / IM / PO

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- 0.6 mg/kg IV / IO/ IM / PO (max dose 10 mg)

IX. Onset

- IV – Rapid

X. Duration

- Hours

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Anaphylaxis
- Tachycardia, Hypertension, CHF
- Hyperglycemia
- Headache, insomnia, personality changes, anxiety, paresthesia
- Immunosuppression & increased risk infection